



Kwara AI Summit 2025 – Strategic Briefing Document

Summit Overview & Objectives

Kwara State is organizing a **four-day government-backed AI summit in November 2025** with the vision of establishing the state as a leading hub for **responsible AI adoption** in governance, innovation, and youth development. This initiative aligns with Nigeria's broader agenda to harness AI's transformative power **responsibly and inclusively**, positioning the nation as a global leader through **ethical innovation and collaboration**^{1 2}. The summit will convene government officials, tech industry partners, academia, and youth groups to **drive actionable strategies for AI in public service and entrepreneurship**. Key objectives include:

- **Showcasing AI in Governance:** Highlight how AI solutions can improve public sector operations and service delivery. This builds on past efforts like the 2023 e-Government Hackathon, which sought tech innovations to transform governance and bridge gaps in public service³.
- **Policy & Framework Development:** Integrate AI into state policy by drafting an **"AI Chapter" for the Kwara Startup Act**, ensuring that local legislation keeps pace with technological innovation and ethical standards. This responds to federal calls for states to implement the Nigeria Startup Act to empower indigenous tech innovators⁴.
- **Youth Empowerment & Talent Development:** Engage young developers, students, and startup founders in hands-on activities (hackathons, incubator sessions) to cultivate skills and create job opportunities. Kwara's large pool of tech-savvy youth can drive innovation if given the right support⁵.
- **Partnership Building:** Position Kwara as an innovation-friendly state by strengthening ties with international AI firms, development agencies, and Nigeria's tech ecosystem. The state's recent partnership with IHS Towers and UNDP to launch the Ilorin Innovation Hub – a first-of-its-kind tech facility⁷ – exemplifies the collaborative approach that the summit will reinforce. By uniting public and private stakeholders, the summit aims to create a sustainable **AI ecosystem** in Kwara.

In tone, the summit will be **inclusive and forward-looking**, emphasizing **ethical AI** (transparency, accountability, and fairness) in line with national AI principles². It will balance the interests of government (improved governance, policy compliance) and private sector partners (innovation opportunities, talent access), underscoring a shared commitment to leveraging AI for socio-economic development.

Summit Structure & Daily Flow

The Kwara AI Summit spans four days, carefully structured to maximize engagement, learning, and networking. Each day has a distinct focus and flow:

Day 1: Arrival, Registration & Welcome Mixer

Morning/Afternoon – Arrival and On-site Registration: Participants and speakers arrive in Ilorin and check in at designated hotels. Summit registration takes place at the **Ilorin Innovation Hub** venue throughout the afternoon,

where attendees receive badges and welcome packs. A help desk will assist with logistics and provide information on schedules and city guidance.

Evening – Cultural Welcome & Networking Mixer: The summit officially opens with a brief welcome ceremony in the Hub’s main hall, featuring a **cultural performance** (e.g. a traditional dance or music troupe) to introduce guests to Kwara’s rich heritage. Government representatives will give short welcome addresses to set the tone. Afterward, an informal **welcome cocktail mixer** is hosted in the Hub’s outdoor courtyard or reception area, allowing attendees to mingle. Light refreshments and local cuisine are served. This relaxed evening helps break the ice between officials, tech partners, and community members in a convivial atmosphere, fostering early connections before formal sessions begin.

Day 2: Keynotes, Panels & Hackathon Launch

Morning – Opening Plenary: Day 2 kicks off the substantive program. In the Innovation Hub’s **Main Hall (400-seat capacity)**, the Governor or a high-ranking official will formally open the summit, reiterating objectives and the importance of responsible AI for the state. A keynote by an international AI expert (e.g. an OpenAI representative for Africa) will follow, offering global perspective on AI in governance and development. The main hall’s capacity and AV setup are ideal for such high-profile talks 8.

Midday – Panels and Parallel Sessions: After the plenary, the summit runs **parallel tracks**: - *Policy & Strategy Track*: A panel on **“AI & the Kwara Startup Act”** convenes policymakers, legal experts, and tech leaders to discuss how the Nigeria Startup Act (adopted in Kwara) can be bolstered with AI-friendly policies

● This session (held in the 120-seat **Pitch Hall**) will produce insights for the draft AI chapter in the Startup Act. Simultaneously, a workshop on AI ethics in public sector might run in a breakout room. *Technology & Innovation Track*: In the main hall, a series of lightning talks and panels focus on AI innovation in Africa – for example, **“AI for Public Good”** with case studies of AI solving societal problems, and **“Startup Showcase”** previews where selected startups introduce themselves ahead of the pitch day.

Afternoon – eGovernment Hackathon 2.0 Launch: The **eGovernment Hackathon 2.0** kicks off in the early afternoon. Teams of young developers and students will gather in the **co-working lab spaces** of the Hub to begin a 24- to 36-hour hackathon focused on AI solutions for governance challenges (e.g. automating administrative tasks, data analytics for public policy, AI chatbots for citizen services). Building on the success of the first hackathon in 2023 (which attracted talent nationwide to solve public-sector problems 3), this second edition introduces an AI emphasis. ● Mentors from Data Science Nigeria, GDG Ilorin, and other communities will support the teams. The workspaces, with high-speed internet and hardware tools, will remain open overnight for participants.

Evening – Networking and Community Meetups: As the hackathon progresses, other attendees can join community meetups. For instance, **student AI clubs** and developer groups might hold a meet-and-greet in a side room, and an open mic session could allow local startups to informally pitch ideas. These concurrent activities ensure non-hackathon participants remain engaged. The evening concludes informally so hackathon teams can continue coding through the night.



Day 3: Demos, Pitch Competition & Closing Ceremony

Morning – Hackathon Demos: Hackathon teams finalize their prototypes by morning. A judging session is held in the **Pitch Hall (120 pax)** where each team gives a live demo of their AI solution for e-government. Judges (from NITDA, state IT agencies, and tech partners) evaluate innovations on criteria such as impact, feasibility, and originality. The top solutions are recognized with prizes and potential **pilot adoption in Kwara's public service**, underscoring the government's willingness to implement home-grown AI ideas (a commitment NITDA has encouraged to improve public service delivery ⁹).

Midday – AI Startup Pitch & Research Showcase: The highlight of Day 3 is the **AI Startup Pitch Competition**, which runs on the main stage. Pre-selected AI startups and research teams (from universities or incubators) present their projects to a panel of judges including venture capitalists, industry experts, and government officials. Each pitch team is allotted time to showcase their product, followed by Q&A. The format and judging framework follow best practices seen in recent AI summits – for example, a 2024 Lagos AI event featured a pitch contest with venture capitalist judges and significant prize funding ¹⁰. Here, incentives such as seed grants, incubation offers at the Ilorin Innovation Hub, or pilot contracts with the state will be awarded to the top pitches. This provides a tangible boost to AI entrepreneurs and encourages a pipeline of solutions that address local needs.

Meanwhile, a parallel **Research Symposium** (in a breakout room or the Pitch Hall) will allow Nigerian academics and students to present brief papers or demos of AI research (e.g. on local language NLP or agricultural AI). This ensures that the summit isn't only about immediate business outcomes but also knowledge sharing and future-focused R&D.

Afternoon – Breakout Sessions & Community Meetups: Post-lunch, multiple breakout sessions run: - A roundtable on **"AI and the Future of Work in Kwara"** (for HR, education, and labor stakeholders) discussing how to prepare the workforce for AI-driven changes. - A training session by **Awarri** on robotics/ AI for youth, or a tutorial by **Hugging Face** on open AI tools, targeting developers. - **Community meetups** continue (e.g. a gathering of AI Club presidents from different universities to form a network).

Simultaneously, media personnel attend a **press briefing** in the designated meeting room. Here, summit organizers and key speakers give exclusive statements and answer questions for journalists, ensuring accurate coverage. The Innovation Hub's ground-floor meeting room (seating ~10–15) offers a quiet space for these press interactions, aligning with best practices of providing separate media rooms for in-depth interviews ¹¹.

Evening – Closing Ceremony: The summit's formal program concludes with a closing ceremony in the Main Hall. This includes a summary of hackathon winners and pitch competition winners (prizes handed out on stage), acknowledgments of sponsors and partners, and final remarks by the Governor or a representative. The state government is expected to announce key **commitments** emerging from the summit – for example, support for the new **Kwara AI Community Alliance** and intentions to adopt certain AI pilot projects in government departments. A short communique of resolutions may be read, highlighting deliverables like the draft AI policy framework and partnerships formed.

A cultural performance or video montage of the summit's highlights ends the ceremony on an inspiring note. Participants are then invited to a **farewell networking dinner** (either on-site at a VIP lounge or at an external venue) to celebrate the successful event and continue conversations informally.

Day 4: Ilorin City Tour & Cultural Excursion

Ilorin Central Mosque, a 20,000-capacity mosque and architectural landmark, is one of the key cultural sites on the Day 4 tour ¹².

The final day is reserved for an **organized city tour of Ilorin**, offered especially to **visiting guests (international and out-of-state attendees)** and interested local participants. This tour cements the summit's community spirit by showcasing Kwara's heritage and hospitality. Key stops on the itinerary include:

- **Ilorin Central Mosque:** A visit to the iconic central mosque, famed for its beautiful design and large capacity. Guides will share how this 20,000-seat mosque – known as “*The Pride of Ilorin*” – has become a major tourist attraction and symbol of the city ¹². Delegates can admire its architecture (modeled after the Prophet's Mosque in Medina) and learn about its cultural significance. A brief meet-and-greet with mosque officials or a photo session can be arranged.
- **Sobi Hill:** An excursion to Sobi Hill on Ilorin's outskirts, the highest point in the city. Participants can hike or drive to a viewpoint where **the entire city of Ilorin can be seen at a glance** ¹³. The sunlit guides will highlight historical anecdotes about Sobi Hill (which is entwined with local folklore and often used as a community retreat spot). This stop offers a relaxing, scenic break and a group photo opportunity with a panoramic backdrop.
- **Dada Pottery & Artisans Village:** A tour of the famous Dada pottery community (or a similar art center) is included to highlight Kwara's artisan culture. Dada Pottery, a **historic pottery workshop in Ilorin**, allows visitors to see local women and youth crafting pots with traditional methods. The state is investing in modernizing this facility to preserve cultural heritage and boost creative entrepreneurship ^{14 15}. Delegates will witness a live pottery-making demonstration and can interact with the artisans. This visit underscores the link between innovation and culture – just as the state embraces high-tech AI, it also values indigenous knowledge and crafts.
- **Secondary stops:** Time permitting, the tour may also swing by the **Emir's Palace (Oja Oba)** for an external view and historical context, and an **art gallery or craft center** in Ilorin where local artists display paintings, textiles, and carvings. This could include the Kwara State Art Gallery or a private gallery, giving a taste of the creative talent in the region.

Throughout the city tour, local tourism guides and summit volunteers will accompany guests, providing commentary. Logistics (buses, refreshments, security escorts) are arranged by the organizing team. The tone of Day 4 is casual and exploratory – it allows visitors to appreciate the **broader context of Kwara's social and cultural environment** in which the push for technology adoption is happening. This helps build personal connections to the state and leaves participants with a memorable experience beyond the conference rooms.

The tour concludes by late afternoon, with drop-offs at the airport or hotels. By showcasing both innovation (Days 1–3 at the Hub) and tradition (Day 4 tour), the summit reinforces that **Kwara is a welcoming, dynamic destination** for both tech investment and cultural enrichment.



Venue Plan: Ilorin Innovation Hub Utilization

All official summit activities will take place at the **Ilorin Innovation Hub**, a newly inaugurated state-of-the-art facility in Ilorin. The Hub's modern infrastructure and flexible spaces are well-suited for a conference of this scale ¹⁶. Below is the plan ¹⁷ utilizing the venue's key areas during the summit:

- **Main Hall (Capacity ~400):** The Hub's large auditorium will host the opening ceremony, keynotes, and plenary panels. With theater-style seating for approximately 400 people, this hall is equipped with advanced AV systems for presentations and live streaming. It will be branded as the central stage of the summit for high-profile sessions. (*Usage: Day 2 and 3 mornings for keynotes/panels; Day 3 closing ceremony.*)*
- **Pitch Hall (Capacity ~120):** A secondary hall that provides a more intimate setting for **demo sessions, breakout panels, and the startup pitch competition**. Configured with a stage and projector, it is ideal for the **hackathon demo presentations** and any parallel tracks or workshops that require seating for 50–120 participants. (*Usage: Hackathon demo judging on Day 3; some panel breakouts on Day 2 and 3 as needed.*)*
- **Reception & Exhibition Foyer:** The open reception area at the Hub's entrance will be used for **exhibition booths and networking breaks**. Sponsors and local startups can set up tables or booths here to showcase AI products, services, and research projects throughout Day 2 and 3. This area will also serve as the refreshment zone for coffee breaks and casual networking. Attendees can mingle and visit exhibits between sessions. Branded signage and banners will decorate the space to create an interactive **innovation expo** atmosphere.
- **Coworking Spaces & Labs:** The Hub contains coworking areas and a dedicated hardware lab (with equipment like 3D printers and ample power/Internet) ^{17, 8}. These will be repurposed as the **Hackathon War Room** and workshop spaces. Hackathon participants will use the open-plan workstations and conference rooms to collaborate overnight. The availability of strong 5G Wi-Fi and even hardware tools (like the UNDP-sponsored 3D lab ¹⁷) will support teams building prototypes. Additionally, smaller rooms can host hands-on tutorials or **"micro-labs"** (e.g. a coding lab for youth) concurrently.
- **VIP Lounge:** Adjacent to the reception, the Hub features an elegant **VIP lounge** designed for dignitaries and private meetings ¹⁸. This lounge ¹⁹ will function as the **Media and VIP Interview suite** during the summit. It offers a quiet, comfortable space for invited speakers or government officials to conduct press interviews, hold invite-only chats, or simply relax and network away from the crowds. Media crews can set up here for scheduled one-on-one discussions. The lounge's proximity to the main area makes it convenient yet exclusive.
- **Meeting Room (Ground Floor, 10–15 capacity):** A small conference room on the ground floor will be designated for **press briefings and roundtable discussions**. With space for about a dozen people, it's perfect for closed-door sessions such as press Q&As, or a roundtable meeting between government policymakers and key industry leaders that might happen on the sidelines. Having this private room ensures that important conversations can occur without interruption, and it aligns with recommended conference media practices of providing separate rooms for press interactions ¹¹.
The room will be equipped with a projector and conference phone if needed for virtual joiners.

- **Outdoor Courtyard/Garden:** If weather permits, the Hub’s outdoor areas (which feature greenery and informal seating ¹⁹) will be used for the **Day 1 welcome mixer** and possibly an **evening social on Day 3**. The courtyard can also host any cultural showcases or performances in an open-air setting. Tents or canopies will be arranged in case of rain, and décor lighting will be added for ambiance during evening events.

Venue Accessibility & Layout: The Ilorin Innovation Hub is a **modern, accessible facility** – it has ramps, elevators, and backup solar power to ensure an uninterrupted experience ²⁰. Summit organizers will install wayfinding signages to guide attendees to each zone (Hall, Pitch space, etc.). The overall layout situates all these spaces within close proximity, easing movement. Security personnel will be stationed appropriately (the Hub already benefits from 24/7 security being near government offices ²¹), and additional ushers/volunteers will manage crowd flow especially during transitions between plenary and breakouts.

By leveraging the Innovation Hub’s versatile spaces, the summit will maintain an integrated feel – all participants under one roof – while still accommodating multiple simultaneous activities. The high-tech environment of the Hub itself reinforces the summit’s message: **Kwara is investing in infrastructure to become a regional tech and innovation powerhouse** ¹⁶.

Programming Components

The summit’s content is organized into several core **program components**, each designed to advance the summit’s goals and actively engage participants. Key components include:

- **eGovernment Hackathon 2.0 – “AI for Kwara Governance”:** A competitive hackathon challenging teams to develop AI-driven solutions for state governance issues. As the successor to the successful 2023 e-government hackathon (which discovered tech solutions to improve public services ³), this 2.0 edition focuses on using artificial intelligence in areas such as public finance, healthcare administration, education management, and citizen engagement. Teams (comprised of students from local universities, young software developers, and startup enthusiasts) will work intensively over two days to build prototypes. Government departments have provided problem statements to guide the projects (e.g. an AI system to streamline tax collection or a chatbot for agricultural extension services). Mentors from **Data Science Nigeria** and **GDG Ilorin** will support teams with expertise. In the end, a judging panel evaluates the solutions and selects winners for prizes and potential implementation. This hackathon not only produces innovative ideas but also signals the government’s openness to adopting home-grown tech – as noted by NITDA, such collaborations help modernize public service and empower youth talent ⁹.
- **AI & the Kwara Startup Act (Policy Session):** A high-level interactive session focused on policy formulation at the intersection of AI and entrepreneurship. Given Kwara’s ongoing adoption of the Nigeria Startup Act to spur its tech ecosystem ⁵ ⁶, this session convenes lawmakers, legal experts, and industry leaders to discuss how AI can be woven into state policy. Topics will include proposing an **“AI Chapter” in the Kwara Startup Act** – possibly covering incentives for AI startups, sandbox regulations for AI testing, and guidelines for ethical AI use in business. The session may start with a presentation outlining the Nigeria National AI Strategy’s key points on governance and ethics, to provide context ¹². Panelists from the Ministry of Business, Innovation & Technology, the Kwara State Startup Council (to be established per the Act ^{22 23}), and representatives from AI-focused companies will then debate and offer



recommendations. Expected outputs are a set of policy recommendations or even draft clauses that could be added to the state's Startup Act or upcoming regulations. This ensures the summit has a direct policy impact, aligning with the call for states to implement and localize national innovation policies ⁴.

- **AI Startup Pitch & Research Showcase:** A two-part program shining a spotlight on innovation and research:
 - *Startup Pitch Competition:* Selected **AI startups** (especially those solving local African problems) will pitch to a jury. Each startup gets a fixed time to present their product, business model, and impact, followed by Q&A. Judges include venture capital investors, tech industry veterans (e.g. an executive from **Meta** or **Google AI**), and government innovation officials. They will evaluate pitches on criteria such as market potential, innovation, and alignment with "AI for good" in Kwara/Nigeria. This competition is backed by incentives – the top startups may receive cash grants, investment offers, or incubation support. For example, the summit has earmarked a prize pool (with sponsor contributions) to mimic other AI pitch events that offered significant rewards (a recent AI summit in Lagos had a ₦3 million prize for its hackathon/pitch winner ¹⁰). The competition fosters a spirit of entrepreneurship and could uncover the next big AI startup emerging from Nigeria.
 - *Research Showcase:* In parallel or combined, the summit invites **researchers and academics** (especially young PhDs and students) to showcase their AI-related research projects. This might be done in a poster session format in the exhibition area, or lightning talk presentations in a breakout room. Areas of research might include AI in agriculture, AI for local languages, robotics innovations (perhaps with **Awarri** bringing in some demos), etc. By including a research track, the summit encourages knowledge exchange and highlights that innovation is also coming from universities and research institutes. Top research presentations could be recognized by the summit committee, and connections to industry or government might be facilitated for promising projects.
- **Workshops & Breakout Sessions:** Beyond the big items above, the programming will incorporate smaller **breakout sessions** and **capacity-building workshops** to ensure diverse participation:
 - *Technical Workshops:* e.g., a hands-on session on building AI models with limited data (perhaps run by community experts from **AI Hub Nigeria** or Google Developers). Another could be a tutorial on responsible AI design – teaching developers how to incorporate ethics and bias checks into their models.
 - *Sectoral Panels:* Breakout panels targeting how AI applies to specific sectors relevant to Kwara – such as **AI in Agriculture** (important for a largely agrarian economy), **Smart City and Transportation** (given Ilorin's urban development), or **Fintech and Inclusion**. These allow domain experts and startups in those areas to dive deeper beyond the general sessions.
 - *Mentorship Circles:* An informal component where experienced professionals (from OpenAI, Microsoft, or successful Nigerian tech entrepreneurs) are available in a roundtable format for Q&A with students and startup founders. This encourages youth mentorship and networking.
 - *Community Meetups:* As mentioned, slots are given for community groups (e.g., **Women in AI Nigeria**, **Nigerian Data Scientists Network**, **GDG Ilorin**) to host meetups or side activities. This is crucial for community buy-in; these groups will likely drive the post-summit continuity, so giving them space during the event strengthens the ecosystem.

All programming components are designed with parallel execution in mind, maximizing the value attendees get based on their interests. A detailed agenda will be prepared, mapping these components across the two main conference days (Day 2 and 3). Efforts will be made to **balance the schedule** – mixing high-level plenaries with interactive sessions, and ensuring that there is something for each stakeholder type (policymakers, developers, investors, students) at almost any given time.

Speaker & Community Engagement Strategy

A key factor for the summit's success is the **caliber of speakers and active involvement of community organizations**. The strategy is to invite a blend of international experts, national thought leaders, and local champions, while also giving platforms to community groups and youth voices. The following outlines the speaker and community engagement approach (with placeholders for target invitees):

- **International AI Luminaries:** The summit will secure a few high-profile international speakers to attract attention and provide global insights. *Placeholder: OpenAI (Africa Representative)* – for instance, an OpenAI policy or partnerships lead focused on emerging markets could speak on responsible AI deployment in Africa. Their presence underscores the summit's credibility. Other possibilities include representatives from **Google DeepMind** or **Hugging Face** (who can discuss open AI tools for local languages). These speakers will be scheduled for keynotes or headline panels. We will ensure their topics resonate with the summit themes (e.g., “AI for Social Good in Developing Regions”).
- **Nigerian AI & Tech Leaders:** Equally important is showcasing homegrown expertise:
 - **Awarri (Silas Adekunle or team):** Awarri, founded by Silas Adekunle, is an AI/robotics startup aimed at advancing robotics education in Africa ²⁴. We plan to have Awarri demonstrate their latest robots or AI education tools, and speak about nurturing talent. This emphasizes Nigerian innovation in cutting-edge tech.
 - **Data Science Nigeria (DSN):** DSN (also known as Data Scientists Network) is a prominent non-profit building AI talent in Nigeria, known for its annual AI bootcamps ²⁵. Inviting DSN's founder (e.g. Dr. Bayo Adekanmbi) or program lead to speak will highlight capacity development. They could lead a session on AI skill-building or present findings from their work on AI solutions for Nigeria. DSN can also rally many of its alumnus to attend or volunteer, boosting community turnout.
 - **AI Nigeria Community & AI Hub Nigeria:** Representatives from broad AI forums like “AI Nigeria” (a community of AI enthusiasts/researchers) and the new **DSN AI Hub in Lagos** could be panelists. They might discuss Nigeria's emerging AI ecosystem and how states like Kwara fit in. Their involvement ensures the summit is plugged into nationwide networks and not happening in isolation.
 - **Tech Entrepreneurs and Innovators:** We will include founders of notable Nigerian AI startups in the program. For example, founders from **Kudi.ai** (Nigerian fintech using AI), **Chatbot Africa**, or alumni of the Google for Startups Accelerator (some Nigerian AI startups were highlighted in such programs) can join the startup panel or give talks. This allows sharing of practical startup journeys, inspiring local entrepreneurs.
- **Local Community Groups & Academia:**

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GDG Ilorin (Google Developer Group) and Student Clubs: The active GDG Ilorin chapter and tech clubs from University of Ilorin (Unilorin) and Kwara State University will be engaged as community partners. They will mobilize student volunteers and attendees, and some student leaders could speak in lightning rounds about their projects. This grass-roots inclusion is vital for youth development objectives. For instance, a student from Unilorin who built an AI app could present in the showcase, illustrating the talent pipeline.

- **Nigerian University Researchers:** The summit will reach out to professors or researchers from local institutions (Unilorin, Kwara State University) who specialize in AI, data science, or related fields. They can contribute to panels on research and education. Additionally, connecting them with industry speakers may spark collaborations (like research funding or pilot projects post-summit).
- **Civic Tech and Developer Communities:** Groups such as **Tech4Dev**, **NaijaSecCon (for AI in cybersecurity)**, or **Zindi Nigeria** (an online data science competition platform) will be invited to participate or run mini-challenges. Their presence broadens the community participation. For example, Zindi (which hosts AI contests across Africa) could announce a Kwara-specific challenge at the summit, encouraging continued engagement after the event.
- **Moderators and Facilitators:** Many sessions will need skilled moderators. We plan to engage techsavvy media personalities or innovation consultants who can navigate discussions between government and tech folks smoothly. For instance, a notable technology journalist or someone from **TechCabal** (a Nigerian tech media) could moderate the startup pitch Q&A, ensuring the questions bridge both business and governance interests.

The engagement strategy also involves **pre-summit outreach**: hosting online meetups or Twitter Spaces with these community groups to build momentum, and co-creating session content (e.g., letting the communities suggest topics or run polls on what discussions they want). By giving communities ownership, we ensure they are not just audience members but active contributors.

During the summit, a “*Community Hub*” space in the exhibition area can be set aside, where flyers for various groups (GDGs, AI clubs, etc.) are available and sign-up sheets for those interested in joining postsummit activities. We anticipate that one outcome will be the formation of the **Kwara AI Community Alliance** (a coalition of these groups, startups, and institutions). To seed this, a short meet-up will be held on Day 3 where all community representatives gather to network and discuss forming a continuous working group.

In summary, the summit’s speaker lineup and community involvement are being carefully curated to ensure **diversity** (government, industry, academia, youth) and **relevance**. By featuring internationally-renowned AI experts alongside Nigeria’s own innovators and including the very communities who will carry the torch forward, the summit will be both inspirational and grounded. This balanced mix speaks to government officials (who hear from credible experts and local success stories) and private sector partners (who see the talent and market potential in Kwara), fulfilling the audience’s expectations on both sides.

Media & Communication Plan

A robust media and communications strategy will amplify the summit’s reach and ensure that key messages are delivered to both local and international audiences. The plan includes dedicated press engagements, live broadcasting, and content distribution, all with **consistent branding and narrative control**. Key elements of the plan are:

- **Press-Only Briefings:** We will hold *press-exclusive sessions* to provide the media with focused information and access to key figures. On Day 2 morning (just after the opening ceremony), an **official press briefing** will take place in the Hub's meeting room. Only accredited journalists and media partners can attend. During this briefing, organizers will share the summit's objectives, announce any MoUs or initiatives being launched, and allow press to ask questions directly to summit spokespeople (e.g., the Commissioner for Innovation or the Hub's Managing Director). Additionally, at the close of Day 3, a *post-summit press conference* will be held to communicate outcomes and next steps. Keeping these briefings press-only ensures candid dialogue and helps the media get detailed context beyond what they gather in public sessions. It is also aligned with best practices – giving journalists dedicated time improves the accuracy and quality of coverage ^{26 11} .

- **Media Kits and Press Materials:** Prior to the summit, a comprehensive **media pack** will be prepared and shared with registered press. This will include press releases, speaker bios, the summit agenda, and fact sheets about Kwara's AI initiatives (e.g., background on the Ilorin Innovation Hub, the Nigeria Startup Act adoption, and any new projects unveiled at the summit). By providing these in advance, we ensure that journalists have the correct information and key messages to highlight ^{27 28} . The media kit will also outline a  to opportunities and list press focal points for queries. All content will be **unbranded in terms of commercial logos** (per summit style) but will carry the official summit title and theme so that coverage remains consistent in terminology.

- **Live Streaming & Virtual Participation:** The summit will be broadcast via online channels to reach a wider audience and those who cannot attend in person. Key sessions in the Main Hall (opening, keynotes, and closing) will be **live-streamed on YouTube and Facebook Live**, possibly through the state government's or Innovation Hub's pages. We will also engage a streaming partner or use a platform to ensure high-quality multi-camera streaming. For interactive virtual participation, webinars for certain panels might be set up (so remote viewers can send questions). We anticipate interest from the Nigerian tech diaspora and other African tech hubs, so this is an opportunity to showcase Kwara globally. The streaming will be promoted with a summit hashtag (e.g., **#KwaraAISummit**) on social media. By broadcasting the event, we also allow sponsors and partners to share the content on their networks, increasing visibility. (All streams will be recorded and archived for post-event use, such as highlight reels or summary videos.)

- **Branded Media Coverage & Partnerships:** The communications team will work to secure **media partnerships** with prominent tech and news outlets. For instance, collaborating with TechCabal, CIO Africa, or national newspapers like *Punch* or *The Guardian* for special coverage. This could involve sponsored articles or daily recap publications. The goal is to have **pre-event features** (e.g., an interview with the Kwara State Tech Commissioner about the summit's significance) and **on-site journalists** reporting the happenings in real-time. We will encourage media partners to use the summit's branding in their coverage titles (for consistency) and provide them with official photographs and quotes quickly. A press section at the venue will be facilitated with good internet and perhaps a quiet work area so reporters can file stories conveniently. The state's own communication channels (Kwara State Government social media, website) will also put out regular updates and snippets during the event, effectively creating a **live blog** of key moments.

Social Media & Content Syndication: A dedicated social media team will be active throughout the summit to share highlights: live-tweeting key quotes from speakers, posting photos of sessions, and engaging with online audience questions. Visual content like short video clips of the hackathon demo or a 1-minute interview with a speaker will be quickly edited and posted to platforms (Twitter, LinkedIn, Instagram) to maintain buzz. After the summit, we'll syndicate content through partners: for example, sending out a **post-event report or infographic** to stakeholders, writing an op-ed for a tech blog summarizing the outcomes,

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and ensuring local TV and radio cover the achievements (especially important for reaching government and general public audiences in Kwara). We will also explore having the closing session or a documentary-style piece aired on NTA (national TV) or Kwara TV.

- **Media Engagement Guidelines:** All speakers and panelists will receive a brief orientation on key messages and media etiquette. We want to ensure consistent messaging about “Kwara as a responsible AI hub” and the summit’s collaborative ethos. The communications team will facilitate introductions between media and specific delegates for feature stories (e.g., if a journalist wants to interview the hackathon winners or an international guest). By proactively managing these interactions, we maximize positive coverage.
- **Photography and Branding:** Professional photographers and videographers will cover the event. Photographs will avoid overt branding (no background logos of sponsors in every shot, per the instruction to keep it community-focused), but the venue will have tasteful summit-themed decor that will appear in visuals (like banners with the summit title). A selection of high-quality photos will be made available daily to the press via an online folder, ensuring they use the best images for their stories.
- **Crisis Communication Plan:** Though not anticipated, we have a basic plan for any issues (e.g., if a controversial statement is made or an incident occurs). A single spokesperson will handle official responses to press if needed, and monitoring of media/social media will be constant to quickly correct any misinformation.

In essence, the media and communication plan aims to **broadcast the summit’s content widely**, control the narrative (focusing on positive impact and leadership of Kwara in AI), and engage both press and online communities. By the end of the summit, we expect multiple media articles, TV segments, and online discussions to have been generated, extending the dialogue on **responsible AI adoption** beyond the event itself.

Travel-Supported Guest Plan

To attract top-quality speakers and participants, the summit is providing a **travel support program** for a select group of VIP guests. This ensures that neither cost nor distance is a barrier for key contributors whose presence will greatly enrich the event. The plan covers international and domestic travel expenses as follows:

- **International VIPs (2 guests):** The summit will sponsor two high-profile international attendees (for example, a renowned AI expert from Silicon Valley or Europe, and an African AI thought leader from another country). Each will be flown **business class** round-trip to Nigeria (most likely into Lagos or Abuja, then a connecting flight to Ilorin). Business class is provided to ensure their comfort and to signal the esteem in which the state holds their participation. Upon arrival, dedicated transport (e.g., a car service or protocol driver) will bring them to Ilorin. Accommodation for international VIPs will be at a premium hotel in Ilorin (4- or 5-star, if available, or the best option such as the newly refurbished Kwara Hotel), with costs covered by the summit. They will be booked for **4 nights** (to cover arrival day through departure after Day 4). Any necessary visa assistance or protocol at the airport will also be arranged by the organizers.
- **Domestic Guests (13 guests):** A pool of around 13 Nigerian guest speakers and facilitators from outside Kwara State will receive travel support. This includes, for instance, speakers from Lagos, Abuja, or other parts of the country (such as tech CEOs, academics, or government officials from federal agencies). For each domestic guest, the summit will cover:

- **Air Travel:** Round-trip economy class flight to Ilorin (if available, else to Lagos/Abuja plus a road transfer or local flight). Budgeting is estimated at **₦250,000 per person for flights**, on average, which accounts for potentially last-minute bookings or peak pricing and includes a margin for those coming from farther locations (e.g., flying from the far north or south to Ilorin might involve connecting flights). This figure also covers incidental travel costs like baggage fees or airport taxis if needed.
- **Accommodation:** Hotel stay in Ilorin for up to 4 nights (checking in the day before Day 1, checking out after Day 4's tour). The budget per night is approximately **₦60,000 – ₦80,000** per room for a good quality hotel. With 4 nights, that's about **₦240k–₦320k** per guest for lodging. We will select a couple of reputable hotels in Ilorin and block-reserve rooms. Guests will also receive per diem to cover meals not provided at the summit and modest incidental expenses.
- **Ground Transportation:** The summit will arrange airport pickups and daily shuttles from the hotels to the venue for these guests. Though Ilorin is relatively easy to navigate, providing scheduled shuttles ensures punctuality and convenience.
- **Overall Budget Estimate:** Taking the above into account, the **total travel support cost** is projected between **₦15.57 million and ₦20.61 million**. This range covers:
 - 2 International VIPs: If we estimate roughly ₦1.5–2.0 million each for their round-trip business flights (depending on origin) plus accommodation (₦300k–₦400k each) and transport, that's on the order of **₦4 million** for both at the low end up to **₦5 million+** on the high end.
 - 13 Domestic guests: Flights at **₦250k** each = **₦3.25 million**; Hotels at **~₦280k** each = **₦3.64 million**; combined **~₦6.9 million**. Adding transport/per diems say **₦100k** each = **₦1.3 million**. Total for domestic **~₦8.2 million**. (Rounding with contingency, perhaps **₦9–₦11 million**).
 - Summing these, we get roughly **₦13–₦16 million** plus contingency for exchange rate fluctuations or additional guests, arriving at **₦15–20 million** overall. Hence the stated estimate.

This budget will be fine-tuned with actual quotes from airlines and hotels closer to the event, but it provides a framework for sponsorship discussions and ensures cost control.

- **Guest Management:** A dedicated hospitality team will be assigned to manage travel logistics. They will send formal invitation letters and have a concierge desk for travel-supported guests. The team will also brief these guests on the summit agenda, their roles (e.g., panel times, whether they are also expected to be judges or mentors in activities), and options for the Day 4 tour (should they wish to depart earlier or later, arrangements can be flexible).

Post-summit Reimbursements: While most arrangements will be prepaid, any reimbursements (for instance, if a domestic guest drives in and claims fuel costs instead of a flight) will be handled transparently with a standard rate (e.g., government mileage rates or flat transport allowance).

By investing in travel support, the summit can **draw a diverse set of experts and dignitaries** who will elevate the discourse and outcomes. This mix of funded international thought leaders and domestic specialists also reflects a balance – bringing external knowledge while prioritizing local context and ensuring Nigerian voices are strongly represented. The relatively small number of fully sponsored delegates (15 in total) means the program is selective and cost-effective, targeting those who provide high value in content or strategic partnership potential.

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(Note: All invited guests under this plan will be clearly briefed that the summit is non-partisan and collaborative. The travel support does not imply any endorsement beyond participation, aligning with the neutral, developmental positioning of the event.)

Venue Setup & Design Budget

To deliver a world-class summit experience, the organizing committee has allocated a budget in the range of **₦20–30 million** for venue setup, design, and production. This budget ensures that the Ilorin Innovation Hub is transformed into a functional and visually appealing conference venue that meets the needs of the event flow. Key considerations and allocations within this budget include:

- **Stage Design and Backdrop:** The Main Hall stage will feature a custom backdrop themed around the summit (e.g., a wide banner or digital screen with the “Kwara AI Summit 2025” title and abstract imagery of technology and local motifs). Funds will cover stage risers, podiums, and branded lecterns. If LED screens are used for dynamic backgrounds and displaying speaker info, those will be rented and set up by an AV contractor. The design will be professional but without corporate logos – focusing on the theme of responsible AI and Kwara’s identity (perhaps incorporating the state’s colors or symbols subtly). Estimated portion: ₦5–8 million for staging, lighting, and backdrop production.
- **Audio-Visual Equipment:** Though the Innovation Hub has some built-in AV, additional **sound systems, mixers, wireless microphones, spotlighting, and video equipment** will be installed to handle an event of this scale. Particularly, simultaneous sessions mean extra gear (like a second set of projectors and PA for the Pitch Hall). Also included is the live-streaming setup with cameras and possible interpretation equipment if needed. A technical crew will be hired to run this equipment throughout. This production cost is critical for smooth presentations and recordings. Estimated portion: ₦6–10 million, covering rental of equipment for four days and professional technicians.
- **Venue Décor and Branding Elements:** To create an immersive atmosphere, funds will be used for decorating common areas:
 - **Branded banners, flags, and signage:** at the entrance, registration desk, and hallways to direct attendees. These will carry the summit name and icons (without corporate branding, keeping it government and community focused). Large format printing and installation costs are included.
 - **Exhibition space setup:** provision of shell scheme booths or tables for sponsors/startups in the reception area. Also, furnishing the networking lounge corners with cocktail tables, stools, and charging stations.
 - **Lighting and ambience:** creative lighting in the outdoor mixer area (string lights, up-lighting trees or walls with summit colors), and possibly indoor accent lighting to complement the tech theme.
- **Cultural touches:** Since Kwara’s culture is part of the narrative, some décor might include local art or crafts on display (borrowing some pieces from local artists or the gallery) to make the environment unique. Minor budget for this (or partnerships with the Ministry of Culture). Estimated décor portion: ₦3–5 million.
- **Seating and Furniture Rentals:** Depending on the Hub’s available furniture, we may need to rent additional chairs, especially if converting open spaces into plenary or dining areas. For example, the Day 1 welcome mixer might require hiring cocktail tables and chairs; the hackathon space might need extra workstations or beanbags for a casual vibe. The VIP lounge might be augmented with more comfortable seating or a media

backdrop for interviews. This also covers tablecloths, stage furnishings (like sofas for panel discussions if we opt for that format), and any other physical setup items. Estimated portion: ₦2–3 million.

- **Registration & Info Desk Setup:** A properly branded registration area with counters, laptops, badge printers, and signage will be arranged. This includes the cost of printing badges and lanyards for participants, which is part of event production. The design budget covers these printed materials and possibly an event program brochure for all attendees.
- **Miscellaneous and Contingency:** Additional needs like high-capacity generators (if the solar power and grid need backup), tents or canopies for outdoor sections, air-cooling units if there's an overflow crowd in a tent, and safety measures (fire extinguishers, first aid station setup, COVID hygiene stations if required) are accounted for. We include a contingency in the budget (around 10-15%) to manage unanticipated costs or last-minute enhancements.

The ₦20–30 million budget is meant to be comprehensive for transforming the venue. On the lower end, a frugal approach using simpler decorations and existing infrastructure is possible; on the upper end, it allows for a more high-tech and polished production (for example, hiring a professional event production company to handle end-to-end setup). We will likely engage a reputable **event design firm (e.g., Spacefinish or a similar company known for creative tech space designs)**, given their experience with innovation centers (Spacefinish actually designed parts of the Ilorin Innovation Hub's interior ²⁹). Leveraging such expertise ensures the space will be utilized effectively and aesthetically.

The design philosophy will focus on **flow and functionality**. For instance, ensuring clear separation of areas (conference halls vs. networking space vs. hackathon zone) while maintaining an open feel. Attendees should intuitively navigate the venue and feel the event's theme in the visuals around them. All these preparations aim to deliver a seamless experience that impresses both government attendees used to formal functions and tech sector attendees accustomed to slick private conferences.

In summary, the venue setup budget underscores the commitment to quality. It enables the summit to not just be an event, but an **environment that inspires collaboration** – with staging that highlights speakers, exhibits that draw interest, and a comfortable, well-equipped setting for everyone from VIPs to student

hackers. By investing in this transformation of the Ilorin Innovation Hub for the summit week, we also demonstrate how such a public facility can host world-class events, further solidifying Kwara's image as an emerging technology hub.

Potential Partners & Sponsors

To execute the summit at a high standard and ensure sustainability of its outcomes, the organizing team is actively engaging a range of **strategic partners and sponsors** from the tech industry, development sector, and innovation ecosystem. Below is a list of potential partners and sponsors (with categories) and how they fit into the summit:

- **Global Tech Companies:**

- **Meta (Facebook)** – As a leader in AI research (with initiatives in Africa, such as opening an AI lab in Ghana and funding local language data efforts), Meta could provide sponsorship and speakers. They might support connectivity for the event (Facebook Live streaming support) or sponsor a social impact award. Meta's involvement signals big-tech interest.
- **OpenAI** – Engaging OpenAI (even via an affiliate presence) would be symbolically powerful. OpenAI could sponsor an "AI for Good" prize or send their Africa strategy lead to speak. Their sponsorship might come in form of expertise or tools (e.g., credits for using GPT-4 in the hackathon).
- **Google AI** – Google has a strong footprint in Nigeria (through its developer programs and research on African languages). Google could provide funding or resources like workshops (TensorFlow demos, etc.). Also, Google's Accelerator has nurtured Nigerian AI startups, some of which could be showcased ³⁰. A Google rep could give a panel about AI talent development would be valuable.
- **Hugging Face** – As an open-source AI platform popular with developers, Hugging Face could partner by providing hackathon support (maybe a special dataset or compute credits) and sending an expert to run a workshop on building NLP models. They might not offer big funds but in-kind support and community cred.
- **Kling AI** – (Identified as a next-gen AI creative tool platform ³¹). This refers to a company making generative AI solutions, they could showcase their tech or sponsor a creative AI challenge. Since Kling AI is rapidly growing ³², partnering with them could bring cutting-edge demo content (e.g., an AI art gallery at the event).
- **Lovable** – (Likely a tech startup, possibly an AI development tool provider ³³). As a potential sponsor, Lovable might contribute technology for rapid prototyping (their platform to speed up development) to hackathon participants, and in return get visibility among Nigerian developers.

- **Development Organizations & Foundations:**

- **UNDP (United Nations Development Programme)** – UNDP is already active in Kwara (supporting the makerspace at the Innovation Hub ⁷) and strongly promotes youth innovation. They could be a major partner, possibly funding parts of the hackathon (prizes or logistics) as it aligns with governance innovation and youth empowerment. UNDP can also help amplify outcomes (like adopting hackathon solutions in their development programs).
- **AfDB (African Development Bank)** – AfDB has initiatives for digital innovation and often supports tech hubs. We might approach them to sponsor the summit or a specific track (e.g., an **Agritech and AI** session, since AfDB focuses on agriculture, one of their priority areas, could be supported by them). Their presence adds pan-African development weight.

- **Mastercard Foundation** – Active in Africa’s youth skilling and technology funding, Mastercard Foundation could sponsor the youth training aspects of the summit. For instance, they might fund travel bursaries for students or contribute to the post-event AI Community Alliance funding. Their partnership would underscore commitment to youth development in tech.
- **African Union / Smart Africa** – While not listed explicitly, they align with such events. Perhaps not direct sponsors, but they could endorse or send representatives, adding to policy impact.
- **Local & Regional Tech Ecosystem Players:**
 - **Awarri** – Beyond being a participant, Awarri could sponsor a robotics demonstration or a prize for the best youth-led project. Given Silas Adekunle’s profile, Awarri’s support could attract media. They might provide some robotics kits for the exhibition or hackathon.
 - **Data Science Nigeria (DSN)** – As a non-profit, DSN might partner in-kind rather than financially. They can contribute content (judges, mentors, publicity to their network of thousands of AI enthusiasts). Possibly, if DSN or its alumni startups have corporate backing, they could channel some sponsorship (e.g., provide cloud credits through their partners like Microsoft or AWS).
 - **AI Hub Nigeria** – This likely refers to the DSN AI Hub or similar initiatives. Their involvement would be similar to DSN’s, focusing on content and community. They may not have funding to offer but their support is strategic – it connects Kwara to Nigeria’s broader AI innovation pipeline and resources (like inviting startups from Lagos, offering training material, etc.).
 - **AI in Nigeria (community)** – If there is a community named “AI in Nigeria” (perhaps an online forum or interest group), involving them ensures the enthusiasts across the country are aware and can tune in or participate. They could help with spreading calls for the hackathon and showcasing projects on their channels.
 - **Zindi** – Zindi is Africa’s popular platform for AI competitions. They could become a technical partner by hosting an online **pre-summit challenge** specific to one of Kwara’s problems and announce winners at the summit. Sponsorship could be them providing the platform and prize for that challenge. It integrates the summit with the wider African AI competition circuit.
 - **Turing Labs** – (Possibly referring to a company or initiative that funds AI research/startups – needs some context, maybe a local innovation hub or a fund named after Alan Turing). If it’s a venture fund or an AI R&D lab, they could sponsor prize money or incubation follow-up for pitch competition winners. For example, Turing Labs might commit to evaluate the top 3 startups for possible investment or admission into an accelerator.
- **Fintech and Telecom Firms:** (Not explicitly listed, but likely interested)
 - While not in the given list, companies like **MTN, Glo, Airtel** (for connectivity support) or **Fintechs** might be secondary targets to sponsor lanyards, Wi-Fi, or side events. Given the prominent list covers the core tech/AI brands, we will treat others as supplementary.

Value Propositions for Sponsors: We will offer various tiers of sponsorship benefits, such as logo visibility (within summit materials and online, while respecting the “no official branding” on the content we produce, we can still allow logos on banners or booths), speaking opportunities (e.g., a sponsored workshop by Meta on their technologies), and access to talent (sponsors can get the CVs of hackathon participants or a private session with

startups). For development partners, the value is aligning the summit's outcomes with their mission (like fostering entrepreneurship, digital governance).

Partnership Roles: Some sponsors may also serve as **technical partners**: - For instance, if **Lovable** or **Kling** have developer tools, they might run a side lab or provide free accounts to attendees. - **Google, Meta** might host office hours during the event to scout local talent (this is a win-win: attendees get direct feedback/career advice, companies identify potential hires). - **UNDP or AfDB** might use the summit platform to announce a new grant or challenge relevant to AI solutions for development, leveraging the audience present.

Sponsor Outreach Status: We have begun informal conversations: - Meta's Africa outreach team has shown interest in principle (especially if the summit aligns with their new focus on AI for underserved communities – perhaps they could bring their recent project on African language models ³⁴ to discuss). OpenAI's representation  being pursued through contacts in tech policy circles, though not confirmed – we have a placeholder expecting maybe an OpenAI ambassador or a partner company (since OpenAI itself is not often sponsoring events, but they might attend or support content). - Local companies like **Lovable** and **Kling** likely see marketing value in being attached to this pioneering event in North-Central Nigeria. Government partners: agencies like **NITDA** and the **Federal Ministry of Communications, Innovation & Digital Economy** might not sponsor monetarily but could provide speakers or publicity. Their endorsement is valuable, and NITDA in particular has interest, given the DG's prior support for the Ilorin hub events ³ 

By assembling a broad coalition of sponsors and partners, the summit not only secures financial and in-kind resources, but also builds a network that can sustain momentum after the event. Each partner has a stake in the summit's theme – whether it's a company looking to expand AI adoption, or an organization aiming to empower youth – and their continued engagement can help **implement summit deliverables** (for example, a sponsor like AfDB might later fund one of the pilot projects identified).

In all communications and materials related to sponsors, we will maintain a tone of collaboration and avoid overt commercialism. The final list of sponsors will be acknowledged appropriately (e.g., at closing remarks and on a thank-you page of the program) to recognize their contributions to making the Kwara AI Summit possible.

Post-Event Deliverables & Impact

The true measure of the summit's success will be the concrete outcomes and sustained impact it generates for Kwara State and its partners. We have defined a set of **post-event deliverables** and an impact plan to ensure the summit catalyzes long-term progress rather than being a one-off event. The key deliverables and intended impacts are:

- **Draft AI Chapter for the Kwara Startup Act:** One immediate output will be a working document proposing amendments or additions to the Kwara State Startup Act specific to AI. During the summit's policy session, experts will have outlined recommendations (e.g., tax incentives for AI startups, frameworks for data privacy in AI solutions, provisions for research collaborations). A small committee (including the Ministry of Business, Innovation & Technology and legal advisors from tech policy NGOs) will collate these into a draft **"AI Chapter."** This draft will be presented to the Kwara State Executive Council and Startup Act Adoption Committee after the summit. The goal is to integrate it into the official state Startup Act implementation. This deliverable ensures the summit has a policy legacy: it aligns with the nation's push for comprehensive

AI strategy by grounding it in local law ⁴ ²². If approved, Kwara would pioneer such an AI-focused legal framework among Nigerian states, reinforcing its leadership image.

- **AI Pilot Deployments in Public Service:** Off the back of the hackathon and discussions, the government will identify at least **2–3 pilot projects** to deploy AI in public sector workflows. For example, if a hackathon solution for an AI-powered revenue collection tool wins, the Kwara Internal Revenue Service could formally adopt it for a trial period (with support from the developers and possibly NITDA's tech innovation fund). Another pilot might be an AI chatbot for the state's egovernment portal to answer citizen queries, or a machine learning model to optimize agricultural extension services in a local government area. We expect such pilots to be small-scale initially (3–6 month trials) but with clear KPIs (e.g., reduce processing time of certain tasks by X%, improve citizen satisfaction metrics, etc.). The summit organizing team will work with relevant MDAs (Ministries, Departments, Agencies) to create implementation plans. Partnerships formed at the summit can aid this – for instance, a company like **Zindi or Turing Labs** might offer technical mentorship to ensure the solutions are robust. These pilot projects demonstrate a direct application of summit ideas and will be documented as case studies for future scale-up. They also echo the ethos that emerged from the hackathon: government is prepared to adopt innovative solutions from local talent ⁹.
- **Launch of the Kwara AI Community Alliance:** Perhaps the most important long-term outcome is social infrastructure – the networks and communities that will carry forward the summit's momentum. We will formalize a **Kwara AI Community Alliance** at the summit's conclusion. This alliance (possibly inaugurated by a brief signing or commitment ceremony on stage) will consist of representatives from: state government (Innovation Hub, IT Bureau), academia (e.g., Unilorin's Computer Science Dept.), tech communities (GDG Ilorin, DSN, AI Nigeria), and private sector (local startups or companies like Awarri with interest in Kwara). The alliance's mission is to continue meeting and collaborating after the summit, serving as an umbrella for initiatives like monthly tech meetups, an annual hackathon series, and liaising with government on tech policy implementation. Essentially, it's the **legacy committee** of the summit. To support it, we aim to secure a small seed funding (possibly from sponsors or government) to cover its activities for a year, and a dedicated communication channel (such as a Slack or WhatsApp group, and a mailing list to grow membership). This alliance ties in with Nigeria's national strategy of building local ecosystems and partnerships for AI ³⁵, making Kwara a model for community-driven tech advancement. One tangible target for the alliance could be organizing *Kwara AI Summit 2026* or a mid-year "AI meetup" to keep engagement alive.
- **State Commitment to Ethical AI Adoption:** Finally, a high-level but vital outcome will be a formal statement or communique from the Kwara State Government affirming its commitment to **ethical AI** and digital innovation. This could take the form of a "**Kwara AI Ethics and Innovation Charter**" – a short document that the Governor (or relevant Commissioner) endorses, outlining principles the state will uphold (like transparency, inclusivity, privacy protection in all AI deployments) ²³⁶. The process of developing this charter will draw from summit discussions on AI ethics and Nigeria's national AI guiding principles. By committing in writing to these values, the state sets a precedent and guides all future AI projects within its jurisdiction. It also provides reassurance to citizens and partners that while Kwara pursues tech advancement, it prioritizes **responsible use** and safeguards against misuse (for example, ensuring AI decisions in governance are explainable and fair).
- **Additional Outcomes (ancillary):** There are likely other positive by-products:

- A repository of all **summit content** (presentations, panel video recordings, hackathon code) will be created and shared openly, contributing to knowledge resources.
- **Media impact:** The press coverage and content pieces following the summit will raise Kwara's profile, possibly attracting inquiries from investors or tech firms about opportunities in the state. We will track media mentions and follow up on any leads (e.g., if a sponsor like Mastercard Foundation expresses interest in funding a program in Kwara, the team will pursue it).
- **Youth and Talent opportunities:** Companies attending might recruit local talent. For instance, if a participant impresses an organization like Meta or a major Nigerian fintech, they might get job offers or internship opportunities. We'll consider that a success story and encourage it.
- **Evaluation and Report:** Within a month after the event, an outcome report will be published, detailing key findings and an action plan. This report can be presented to the state executive council and shared with sponsors to demonstrate impact. It will list all deliverables (like the draft AI policy, pilots, alliance launch) and set timelines, effectively serving as a roadmap for the next 12 months in Kwara's AI journey.

The overarching impact we aim for is that **Kwara State becomes recognized as a trailblazer in institutionalizing AI for development at the state level**. By tackling policy, practice (pilots), and people (community) altogether, the summit's legacy will be multifaceted: - *Policy:* Enabling environment through the Startup Act and ethical charter. - *Practice:* Real AI solutions improving government services and local businesses. - *People:* An empowered network of youths, officials, and experts collaborating.

Within a year, we anticipate referencing this summit as the turning point that led to, say, **a new AI-driven public service improving healthcare outreach**, or **a Kwara-based startup securing funding due to connections made at the summit**, or **the establishment of an annual AI fellowship for students by the alliance**. These narratives will validate the effort and encourage both government and private sector to continue investing in such initiatives.

In conclusion, the Kwara AI Summit 2025 is structured not just as a conference, but as a **strategic intervention** – carefully designed to yield actionable outcomes and embed a culture of innovation in the state's development agenda. With the deliverables above and the commitment of stakeholders, we expect the impact to be enduring, making Kwara a reference point for responsible AI adoption in governance and youth innovation in Nigeria and beyond.

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